

Pin Oak

Quercus palustris



Origin

Native to the eastern and central United States, especially in low, poorly drained soils near rivers and floodplains.

Look for

Its branching pattern is a giveaway: upper branches point up, middle branches stick out level, and lower branches often droop toward the ground -- a three-tiered silhouette visible from a block away.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf: deeply cut, pointed, bristle-tipped lobes -- almost star-shaped.
- Branches: three visible layers -- up, level, drooping down.
- Acorn: small, round, shallow cap, takes two years to mature.
- Commonly confused with: Northern red oak (pin oak's lobes are narrower and its branch layering is more pronounced).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Reddish new leaves unfold with the flowers.
Summer	Glossy, deeply cut leaves form a dense pyramid-shaped crown.
Fall	Leaves turn bronze-red and often stay on the tree into winter.
Winter	Distinctive drooping lower branches and small round acorns.

DID YOU KNOW

- One of the fastest-growing oaks, which is why it became such a popular street and park tree in the 20th century.
- Like other red oaks, its acorns take two full years to mature on the branch before falling.